

FIT FOR THE ROLE
Manipur CM N. Biren Singh exercising at an open gym in Imphal

A FINE BALANCE

A period of relative peace has allowed Manipur to concentrate on development both for its hill tribes and its plainspeople

By KAUSHIK DEKA

Any fair and competitive assessment of the performance of India's 10 small states is a task fraught with great difficulty. The diversity in geography and strategic significance add more challenges to the process. If Delhi is the capital of India, Goa is the most attractive tourist destination of the country. Down south, Puducherry, with its quaint charm and scenic beauty, has its own attractions. On the other end of the spectrum are the seven northeastern states, where—barring Assam—economic progress entered late given their distance from the mainstream and political apathy.

Yet, the India Today State of the States study